FREE POSTER

Public and Private Places



A sorting poster for home, school and residential settings. Print, laminate and put it up where everyone can see it.

WHO IT IS FOR

Autistic children and young people, with the parents, carers, teachers and SNAs who support them.

NCCA STAGE

Primary (all classes) · Junior Cycle · Special classes and special schools



Easy read

Some places are public. Lots of people can be there. Some places are private. You can be on your own there.

How to use this resource

- Print page 2 on A4, or enlarge it to A3 for a classroom wall. Laminate it so it lasts.
- Use page 3 at home: stick photos of your own rooms in the boxes, so the poster shows the real places your child knows.
- Use the same words every time, at home and at school: **'That's private. Bedroom or bathroom.'**
- Teach the poster before you need it, at a calm time, not just after something has gone wrong.

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Version 1.0 · public-and-private-places

Public and private places

Public

- Classroom
- School yard and corridor
- Shop
- Bus and car
- Park and playground
- Kitchen and sitting room
- The internet

Private

- My bedroom, door closed
- Bathroom, door locked
- Toilet cubicle, door locked
- Changing cubicle

Private things happen in private places.

In public, I keep my clothes on.

The internet is public. A photo online is public.

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My public and private places at home

Stick a photo of each room in a box, or draw it. Write the name under it. Then tick public or private.

Photo of room

Name: _____ ☐ Public ☐ Private

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Photo of room

Name: _____ ☐ Public ☐ Private

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Photo of room

Name: _____ ☐ Public ☐ Private

© autismandme.ie

Photo of room

Name: _____ ☐ Public ☐ Private

© autismandme.ie

Photo of room

Name: _____ ☐ Public ☐ Private

© autismandme.ie

Photo of room

Name: _____ ☐ Public ☐ Private

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Notes for adults

- A bedroom is only private when the door is closed and nobody else is there. If a child shares a bedroom, agree a private place and time with them.
- Respond to private behaviour in a public place calmly and without shame: name the place, then redirect. 'That's private. You can do that in your bedroom.'
- Model it yourself: knock before you open a closed door, and teach your child to knock too.
- Agree the same words with school and any respite or residential setting, so the rule is the same everywhere.

Curriculum links

NCCA and Department of Education alignment

- Primary SPHE (1999), strand **Myself**, strand unit *Taking care of my body* and *Safety and protection*; supported by the Stay Safe programme.
- Junior Cycle SPHE (2023), Strand 3 **Relationships and Sexuality**: privacy, boundaries and respect for self and others.
- NCCA guidance on RSE for students with special educational needs: teach public and private explicitly, with visual supports, and keep the language consistent between home and school.

Universal Design for Learning

Every Autism & Me resource offers more than one way in: pictures and words together, an easy-read line, things to do with your hands, and scripts to practise. Keep the learning aim the same for everyone, and change the route. No diagnosis is needed to use any support in this resource.

Getting support in Ireland

Emergency

112 or 999 — Gardaí, ambulance or fire. Use it if someone is in danger now.

Childline (ISPCC)

Free, 24 hours: phone 1800 66 66 66, text 50101, or chat at childline.ie. For anyone under 18.

Tusla – Child and Family Agency

Report a worry about a child's safety to your local Tusla social work duty team. Contacts at tusla.ie.

Parentline

Support for parents and carers: 01 873 3500, parentline.ie.

Your school

Talk to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) for child safeguarding, a class tutor or year head.

Autism & Me

Questions about this resource or training for your school: contactautismandme@gmail.com · autismandme.ie

If a child tells you something worrying

Stay calm. Listen, and believe them. Do not promise to keep it a secret. Write down what they said in their own words, with the date. Pass it on the same day: in a school, to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP); otherwise to Tusla. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 112 or 999. Follow *Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children* (2017).

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